

ABHINAV SHARMA

(+1) 319-333-5075 • absharma@berkeley.edu • linkedin.com/in/ab-sharma

EDUCATION

University of California, Berkeley, Haas School of Business, Berkeley, CA **Expected May 2028**
Master of Business Administration

University of Michigan, Ann Arbor, MI **Sep 2019 | Dec 2016**

Ph.D. | M.S.E., Aerospace Engineering

- Dissertation: Development and Application of a Comprehensive Simulation for Modeling Helicopter Ship Landing; published in Journal of Aircraft (2021)

The University of Iowa, Iowa City, IA **May 2015**

B.S.E., Mechanical Engineering; Minor: Mathematics

EXPERIENCE

Continuum Dynamics, Inc., Ewing, NJ **Feb 2020 – Feb 2026**

R&D firm in rotorcraft, fixed-wing, and advanced air mobility (AAM) aeromechanics

Staff Associate (R&D and Business Development)

- Captured \$1.44M in DoD and NASA awards—including a \$1.15M STTR Phase II award—by identifying and qualifying SBIR/STTR opportunities, shaping technical solutions, and leading proposal development end-to-end
- Led a 6-person industry-academic team and navigated IP and workshare constraints to align the solution with government requirements
- Drove customer discovery and iterative technical development with U.S. Army Research Laboratory (ARL) to deliver a Python MDO framework for morphing UAV design, achieving software adoption for advanced morphing aircraft research
- Generated \$100K in new AAM revenue by prospecting and closing two startup customers for aircraft design and performance-analysis engagements, expanding the company's client base into the emerging AAM market

Airspace Experience Technologies, Inc., Detroit, MI **Nov 2019 – Jan 2020**

Early-stage startup developing an advanced air mobility aircraft

Lead Aircraft, Controls and Simulations Engineer

- Defined simulation strategy for aircraft development program, designing a 6-DOF flight dynamics framework that served as technical blueprint for all future design analyses
- Evaluated technical specifications from 5+ EV component suppliers against aircraft design requirements, delivering a sourcing recommendation that informed the startup's conceptual design decisions

The University of Michigan, Ann Arbor, MI **Jan 2017 – Oct 2019**

Aerospace Engineering Department

Graduate Research Assistant

- Developed a Fortran-based simulation framework for modeling helicopter approach and landing on moving ship decks, integrating flight controls, landing gear dynamics, and ship airwake under an Office of Naval Research grant
- Applied the framework to UH-60A shipboard operations, identifying a 17% reduction in main-rotor power requirements near moving ship decks and providing insights for Navy rotorcraft operations research

ADDITIONAL

- Conducted 50+ customer-discovery interviews across aerospace to identify and validate unmet needs in MRO and autonomy, informing pre-MBA venture opportunity assessment (Feb 2026 – Aug 2026)
- Vertical Flight Society (VFS) Modeling & Simulation Technical Committee (elected member); Muay Thai amateur competitor (3 sanctioned bouts)
- Languages: French, Hindi, Spanish (Intermediate), Korean (Beginner)